

Description & Eligibility

Teams will develop and present a comprehensive, data-driven global marketing plan that includes market research, target market analysis, pricing strategies, and integrated promotional strategies aligned with current industry practices and ethical standards. Any secondary contestant may enter this judged team event. A team will consist of 2-4 contestants. Teams must be registered for the national competition before the submission deadline and compete in both parts of the event to be ranked. Entries that do not follow the provided topic or the Copyright and/or Fair Use Guidelines and the Artificial Intelligence Usage & Citation Policy will be disqualified.

Topic

A fictional European climate-tech startup, UpWardLink Solutions, has developed EcoSphere, an AI-driven platform designed to help small and medium-sized businesses measure, report, and reduce their carbon footprint. EcoSphere automates emissions tracking, provides industry-specific reduction strategies, and connects companies with certified sustainability partners.

As governments worldwide tighten environmental reporting regulations, including expanded ESG requirements, carbon taxes, and supply chain transparency laws, demand for affordable emissions-management tools is surging. While EcoSphere has gained rapid adoption in the European Union, the company is now preparing for global expansion into new markets where sustainability compliance is becoming increasingly urgent.

Team Must Supply

- For each round of presentations (preliminaries and finals) contestants may share supporting materials (e.g., research charts, brochures, etc.). These materials may be used during the presentation but must not be left with the judges.
- Students may use one single-sided laptop, notebook, or tablet for their presentation. Projection equipment and external displays will not be provided or permitted.
- Optional - Product displays and props (product samples and promotional items), prepared posters, flip charts, easels, or graphs in presentation.

Contest Notes

- Method of evaluation: judged
- AI Policy Level 2 *Permitted with Citation*
- Only one (1) team member should complete the submission
- Carry-in and setup of equipment must be done solely by the team within the time allotted
- No Internet access will be provided on-site at NLC; however, teams may provide their own access to be used only for their presentation to the judges
- Length of event: no more than three (3) minutes setup, no more than ten (10) minutes oral presentation, and no more than five (5) minutes judges' questions
- Finals may be part of the competition
- Each state is allowed three (3) entries

Technical Pre-Submit Specifications

What to Submit at https://upload.bpa.org	Saved File(s) Name	National Deadline
Submitting all the following in one combined PDF: 1. Marketing Plan with the Title Page and Table of Contents 2. Works Cited 3. BPA Release Form(s) 4. AI Usage and Documentation Form	GMST-TeamID.pdf	April 1, 2027, 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time

Contest Competencies

1. Develop a comprehensive, data-driven global marketing plan
2. Conduct and communicate marketing research and insights
3. Define, segment, and analyze domestic and global target markets
4. Develop and justify value-based pricing strategies
5. Apply customer relationship management (CRM) and customer engagement strategies
6. Design integrated marketing campaigns across digital, social, traditional, and experiential platforms
7. Collaborate effectively in diverse, cross-functional global marketing teams
8. Deliver compelling, data-backed presentations using interactive and multimedia formats
9. Apply ethical, legal, and socially responsible marketing practices

Contest Specifications for this Event

- The Marketing Plan, including the Title Page, Table of Contents, and Works Cited must be formatted according to the *Style & Reference Manual*.
- The Marketing Plan must not exceed ten (10) pages single-sided and must follow the Marketing Plan format (Sections I-X) in the *Style & Reference Manual*. All other documentation is not considered to be part of the ten (10) single-sided pages. The Title Page, Table of Contents, and Works Cited are not included in the ten (10) page limit.
- Any Marketing Plan submitted beyond the maximum number of pages will be *disqualified*.

Common Specifications for all BPA Judged Events

- This is a pre-submitted event. Regional and state conferences have specific deadlines prior to the national deadlines. Please consult the regional or state conference administrator for those deadlines. For the National Leadership Conference, submit project files at <https://upload.bpa.org> no later than 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on April 1, 2027.
- The team is responsible for securing a signed BPA Release Form(s) from any person, including themselves, whose image or work is used in the project.
- The team is responsible for citing all sources, including themselves, on the Works Cited page for any work used on the project. It is the policy of Business Professionals of America to comply with copyright law. The *Style & Reference Manual* contains guidelines for Copyright and/or Fair Use. Contestants will be disqualified for violations of the guidelines.
- Materials must follow the organization's BPA Graphic Standards and make proper use of the BPA logo and/or organization's name. Refer to the BPA Graphic Standards in the *Style & Reference Manual*.
- Judges' comments will be returned digitally through the online judging system at the national level. Materials submitted for technical judging will *not* be returned and will *not* be available at NLC.

500 Global Marketing Strategy Team

Technical Scoring Rubric

Required Elements (If any question results in a NO, please assign a score of 0)				
Team followed the topic.				☐ Y ☐ N
Team followed the Copyright and/or Fair Use Guidelines and Artificial Intelligence Usage & Citation Policy.				☐ Y ☐ N
Marketing Plan did <i>not</i> exceed ten (10) pages single-sided. The Title Page, Table of Contents, and Works Cited are not included in the ten (10) page limit.				☐ Y ☐ N
If answered no to any question, please stop scoring and provide a brief reason for the <i>disqualification</i> :				
Submission and Formatting (All points or none are awarded by the technical judge)				
Team submitted one (1) combined PDF file containing their Marketing Plan to include the Title Page, Table of Contents, Works Cited formatted according to the <i>Style & Reference Manual</i> , BPA Release Form(s), and AI Usage and Documentation Form.				/10
Evaluation Criteria	Below Expectations 0-8 points	Meets Expectations 9-16 points	Above Expectations 17-25 points	Points Awarded
Synopsis or Mini-Plan for Business	The executive summary is unclear.	The executive summary is clear and concise.	The executive summary is clear, concise, and generates strong interest.	/25
Company Goals	Goals are vague or unrealistic.	Goals are mostly clear and realistic.	Goals are very clear and realistic.	/25
Description of Customer Needs	Target market is poorly defined.	Target market is adequately defined.	Target market is precisely defined with demographics.	/25
Description of Pricing Strategy	Pricing strategy is vague or unclear.	Pricing strategy is clear and includes profit margins.	Pricing strategy is detailed, including profit margins and break-even analysis.	/25
Competition	Limited analysis of competition.	Adequate analysis of competition.	Comprehensive analysis of competition.	/25
Marketing Mix	Marketing mix is unclear or incomplete.	Clear and mostly complete marketing mix.	Detailed and complete marketing mix.	/25
Economic, Social, Legal, Technological Trends	Limited or irrelevant research on trends.	Adequate research on trends.	Extensive and relevant research on trends.	/25
Human Resources Requirements	Organizational structure is unclear.	Clear organizational structure.	Well-defined organizational structure.	/25
Marketing Timeline	Incomplete or unrealistic timeline.	Complete and somewhat realistic timeline.	Comprehensive and highly realistic timeline.	/25
Methods of Measuring Success	Success metrics are vague or unrealistic.	Success metrics are mostly clear, realistic, and adequately defined.	Success metrics are exceptionally clear, highly realistic, and well-defined.	/25
Evaluation Criteria	Below Expectations 0-5 points	Meets Expectations 6-10 points	Above Expectations 11-15 points	Points Awarded
Overall Appearance, Conciseness, and Completeness	Plan is disorganized, wordy, or missing sections.	Plan is well-organized, concise, and complete.	Plan is exceptionally well-organized, concise, and thoroughly complete.	/15
Writing Accuracy	Frequent grammar or spelling errors.	Contains some grammar or spelling errors.	Contains very few or no grammar or spelling errors.	/15
TOTAL TECHNICAL POINTS				/290

500 Global Marketing Strategy Team

Presentation Scoring Rubric

Required Elements (If any question results in a NO, please assign a score of 0)				
Team followed the topic.				☐ Y ☐ N
Team followed the Copyright and/or Fair Use Guidelines and the Artificial Intelligence Usage & Citation Policy.				☐ Y ☐ N
If answered no to either question, please stop scoring and provide a brief reason for the <i>disqualification</i> :				
Evaluation Criteria	Below Expectations 0-5 points	Meets Expectations 6-10 points	Above Expectations 11-15 points	Points Awarded
Delivery & Engagement	Team rarely maintains eye contact, uses minimal gestures and body language, or has significant inconsistencies in tone and pace.	Team occasionally breaks eye contact, uses limited gestures and body language, or has some inconsistencies in tone and pace.	Team maintains good eye contact, uses appropriate gestures and body language, and varies their tone and pace adequately.	/15
Organization, Design & Structure	Presentation lacks coherence, and it is unclear how each team member's role contributes to the presentation. Transitions between speakers and/or points are awkward or absent.	Presentation content has some gaps, and it is not always clear how each team member's role contributes to the presentation. Transitions between speakers and/or points are choppy.	Presentation content flows adequately, and each team member's role is clear and integrated into the presentation. Transitions between speakers and/or points are smooth.	/15
Evaluation Criteria	Below Expectations 0-15 points	Meets Expectations 16-30 points	Above Expectations 31-45 points	Points Awarded
Content Knowledge	Presentation demonstrates a limited understanding of the topic and includes mostly irrelevant or inaccurate information.	Presentation demonstrates a basic understanding of the topic and includes a mix of relevant and irrelevant information.	Presentation demonstrates a good understanding of the topic and includes relevant and accurate information.	/45
Evaluation Criteria	Below Expectations 0-4 points	Meets Expectations 5-7 points	Above Expectations 8-10 points	Points Awarded
Judges' Questions	Responses lack depth and fail to demonstrate a comprehensive understanding of the topic.	Some responses lack detail or clarity. The understanding of the topic is partially demonstrated.	Responses are detailed, insightful, and effectively address the judges' questions.	/10
Team Members	At least two original team members were present during the presentation.			/5
Timing	Setup lasted no longer than three (3) minutes, and the presentation lasted no more than ten (10) minutes.			/10
TOTAL PRESENTATION POINTS				/100

Props and/or additional items shall not be used as a basis for scoring.

PRESENTATION WILL BE STOPPED AT TEN (10) MINUTES